

extract-tracker-cookies

extract-tracker-cookies.sh

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Overview

Extracts **only** a single tracker's own-domain cookies from a Netscape cookies.txt browser export and emits the name=value; name=value header string consumed by the merge proxy's *_COOKIES env vars (NNMCLUB_COOKIES, RUTRACKER_COOKIES, and IPTORRENTS_COOKIES — added 2026-08-18, Task #39).

Built because nnmclub (Cloudflare Turnstile), rutracker (CAPTCHA-walled login), and iptorrents (login-form-only, no unattended POST path) cannot be authenticated by an unattended password POST — the reliable path is operator-supplied browser cookies. Operators routinely have a *full* browser cookies.txt (every site they're logged into); this tool pulls just the one tracker's cookies so the rest of the jar never reaches .env.

Prerequisites

- A Netscape cookies.txt export (tab-separated: domain flag path secure expiry name value).
- The export must be from a session that is **logged into the tracker** (else the required session cookie is absent → exit 2).

§11.4.10 privacy guarantee

A full browser cookies.txt contains the operator's ENTIRE cookie jar (banking, shopping, email, payments). This tool:

- emits cookies for the requested tracker's **canonical own domain only** (nnmclub.to / rutracker.org / iptorrents.com) — every other site's cookies are discarded;

- de-dups by cookie name (first occurrence wins) so a mirror domain's divergent session value never collides with the canonical host's;
- logs only cookie **names + counts** to stderr — **never values**;
- writes the header string to **stdout** for the caller to redirect into a `chmod 600 .env` (the value is never echoed to a log or the terminal).

Usage

```
# Capture into an env var (value never printed):
NNMCLUB_COOKIES="$(scripts/extract-tracker-cookies.sh ~/Downloads/
    nmclub.txt nmclub)"
RUTRACKER_COOKIES="$(scripts/extract-tracker-cookies.sh ~/
    Downloads/rutracker.txt rutracker)"
IPTORRENTS_COOKIES="$(scripts/extract-tracker-cookies.sh ~/
    Downloads/iptorrents.txt iptorrents)"
```

Edge cases

- **Required session cookie absent** (phpbb2mysql_4_sid for nmclub, bb_session for rutracker, pass for iptorrents) → exits **2** with an honest message; the export was not from a logged-in session.
- **Unknown tracker** → exit 1.
- Mirror-domain rows (.rutracker.net, .nmclub.me) are intentionally ignored — only the canonical domain that matches the proxy base_url.
- IPTorrents authenticates via a two-cookie pair (uid=<numeric id> + pass=<32-char hash>); pass is the load-bearing secret and is the required canary — uid alone (low entropy, easily-guessable) proves nothing about login state.

Related

- scripts/load-tracker-cookies.sh — the caller for rutracker / nmclub / iptorrents; rutor / kinozal use an inlined copy of this same awk shape since they don't need session-cookie validation the same way.
- scripts/nmclub-cookie-refresh.sh — applies the extracted/harvested NNMCLUB_COOKIES into .env and restarts the proxy.
- download-proxy/src/merge_service/search.py — consumes NNMCLUB_COOKIES, RUTRACKER_COOKIES, and IPTORRENTS_COOKIES as the preferred auth path.

*Last verified: 2026-08-18 against real nnmclub.txt / rutracker.txt /
iptorrents.txt exports (session cookie present, foreign-site cookies
provably excluded, no dup names).*